

**SOLUTIONS<sup>3</sup>**

## Cyberside Chats: Summer Edition

### Weekly Recap

#### Special points of interest:

- Teamwork As a Foundation
- What The Internship Taught Us About Learning
- DVMS NIST CSF Exam Prep
- Hack The Box Highlights

Welcome to the 10th and final edition of Cyberside Chats! The Solutions3 interns had their last full week as they began preparation for their final presentation!

The group began the week with their usual weekly start meeting where they learned about the last tasks assigned within the Risk Management pathway. The interns were tasked with completing Hack the Box modules including vulnerability assessment and introduction to digital forensics, as well as creating their very own vulnerability scan and report of a small business.

Then, on Tuesday they had a Professional Development Session with a concentration on presentation and storytelling skills. The session gave insights on how to become a stronger presenter and tools for improved storytelling.

The interns learned about the simple yet effective format for storytelling in addition to lessons about delivery skills. We hope to see the skills learned transition to our big presentation next week!

Later on in the week, the interns learned about Security Scorecard from Solutions3' Mike Battistella through the stand in Vendor of the Week session. Mike taught the interns about the online cybersecurity rating platform and gave a brief demonstration on the platform's interface.

Lastly, the interns had their final capture the flag event on the Hack the Box platform. Interns were split into their pathway groups as they navigated the timed online skills event together. Overall, the group was very busy and we cannot wait to show everyone our final presentation next week!



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### Vendor of the Week

Our vendor of the week was SecurityScorecard, presented by our President, Mike Battistella. This site is a leading cybersecurity ratings platform that provides a comprehensive scan of an organization's overall security posture. Interns were able to see how this

tool enables organizations to manage risk proactively, as well as look at the capabilities to showcase vulnerabilities of other organizations in real-time. Its sleek interface and detailed reporting make it a leading tool for both internal assessments and third-party risk

management to navigate how a bad actor may think to find any gaps in an organization's system. Huge thank you to Mike for spotlighting SecurityScorecard this week, giving interns a close look on improving cyber readiness for organizations.

## Building Falconi, Building a Team



Throughout our internship with Solutions<sup>3</sup>, and in the development of Falconi, teamwork wasn't just a theme, it was the foundation of everything we built. From conducting OSINT reconnaissance to writing risk reports and coordinating deliverables, collaboration meant learning how to communicate clearly, respect different working styles, and move as one unit even when our schedules didn't always align.

A major lesson was recognizing that everyone works differently. We had to stay mindful of time management, adjust to each other's internal rhythms, and take ownership not just of tasks, but of shared momentum. That meant scheduling smarter, speaking up early, and giving each other room to grow.

Interns leaned on one another for ideas, accountability, and honest feedback. Our leaders, Mike, Shannon, Kristen, and Mark, set

the tone with a balance of structure and trust that gave us space to learn, make mistakes, and build something real.

At Falconi, we didn't just work together, we became a team.

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*"This experience will stay with us and continue to shape how we approach learning in the future."*

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## Learning How to Learn

This summer at Solutions<sup>3</sup> was a rewarding experience that fostered both growth and learning. We strengthened our professional development skills and engaged in hands-on technical work, including working with packet tracers and analyzers, creating network diagrams, designing an incident response plan, and building a solid foundation in risk management.

A highlight was completing real-world cybersecurity modules through Hack The Box, where we explored topics such as Open Source Intelligence and Vulnerability Assessment. These exercises challenged us to think critically and adapt quickly.

Most importantly, we learned how to learn. Many tasks were unfamiliar and complex, but by applying strategies like Black Box learning,

treating each problem as a system to explore through trial, feedback, and iteration, we were able to grasp complex concepts more effectively. This experience will stay with us and continue to shape how we approach learning in the future.

## DVMS NIST CSF Exam Prep



This summer, a key element of our cybersecurity internship involves having interns train for the DVMS NIST Cybersecurity Professional Foundations (3) Exam. This training is essential because it ensures our interns understand the CSF framework and can identify and mitigate

risks according to industry standards. By covering the five core functions (Identify, Protect, Detect, Respond, and Recover), we strengthen our skills to reduce the likelihood and impact of potential incidents. Weekly study sessions enhance our individual knowledge and promote

collaborative problem-solving, a vital skill for addressing real-world threats. Ultimately, the interns are building the expertise and confidence needed to excel on the exam and in future cybersecurity roles.

## Professional Development Recap

This week's Professional development session focused on our presentation and storytelling skills. We started by participating in a 60-second ice-breaker selfie game, in which we all presented short stories of ourselves in under a minute. Once we had gauged our current skills, we moved on to learning new techniques to enhance our presentation skills.

We first learned about how our presentation should flow by

establishing the setting, breaking down the conflict, explaining our action in response, and showing the outcomes at the end. We also had to be aware of who our audience is while we present, keeping in mind to tailor our tone, language, and visuals based on our audience. One good rule to follow while presenting is sticking to the rule of 3, in which any major topics should be no more than three points to retain maximum attention.

With these skills, and after a short series of mock presentations, all interns are now more confident in their presentation skills. No doubt this will be extremely helpful in the coming week, as interns prepare for their final presentation.



## Hack The Box Highlights

Throughout our internship, Hack The Box provided an engaging and practical platform to sharpen our cybersecurity skills. We worked through real-world incident response and risk management scenarios, gaining hands-on experience with industry-standard tools such as Wireshark, Nessus, Elastic, and more. These exercises allowed us to go beyond theory, applying

what we learned to solve challenges similar to those professionals face in the field every day.

Our training culminated in a final project where we conducted a Vulnerability Assessment for a real small business. This capstone experience allowed us to apply all the skills we had developed, identifying risks, analyzing security gaps, and recom-

mending improvements in a real-world setting.

We'd like to thank Hack The Box for sponsoring the internship and providing this training experience, and a special thanks to Floyd and Chandler for their guidance and support throughout the program.

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*"These exercises allowed us to go beyond theory, applying what we learned to solve challenges that professionals face."*

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## Did You Know?

In 2017, hackers stole 10GB of data from a North American casino, all through an internet-connected fish tank. The high-tech tank was designed to automate feeding and monitor water conditions, but it also offered a weak point into the casino's network. Hackers exploited the

tank's connectivity to move laterally across systems and exfiltrate sensitive data to a server in Finland. The breach went unnoticed until cybersecurity firm Darktrace detected the suspicious activity.

This incident is a reminder that any IoT device, even a fish tank,

can present a serious risk. As IoT devices become more common in workplaces, organizations must prioritize network segmentation and device monitoring to reduce vulnerabilities and prevent creative attacks like this one.



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*At Solutions<sup>3</sup> LLC, we believe that empowering people is the key to sustainable success in cybersecurity, IT, and business service management as a whole. Our commitment to resource development is evident through mentorships, advanced training, and workforce development programs, including impactful internships and apprenticeships.*

*For more information on our internships, workforce development, or training, contact Mike Battistella at [mike@solutions3llc.com](mailto:mike@solutions3llc.com) or Shannon Conley at [shannon.conley@solutions3llc.com](mailto:shannon.conley@solutions3llc.com).*

## Special Thanks to Our Sponsors

We are grateful for the generous support and partnership of the following organizations, whose contributions help make the Summer Cybersecurity Internship Program possible. Their support enables us to provide hands-on learning experiences, real-world simulations, and invaluable mentorship opportunities for our interns.



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## Editor's Corner

Thank you for reading the final edition of our Cyberside Chats Newsletter!

It's hard to believe we're in Week 10 - the last week of our internship at Solutions<sup>3</sup>. This experience has been incredibly rewarding. Coming in, I wasn't sure what to expect, but working alongside such a passionate team and my fellow interns has made every week memorable.

What made this internship truly stand out was the project-based learning style. Working through real-world scenarios with our mock company "Falconi" helped us apply technical concepts and develop professional skills in an engaging way. It challenged us to think like cybersecurity professionals - not just trainees.

I'd like to give a huge thank you to Mike Battistella, Mark Marino, Shannon Conley and Kristen Nova for your leadership and encouragement thus far. We couldn't have gotten this far if it wasn't for you guys!

Big shoutout to Floyd Haynes for always bringing the energy and keeping things real. And thank you to Hack The Box for allowing us to use your platform. Every training and CTF event definitely sharpened our skills. (and humbled us more than once).

Finally, thank you to my fellow interns: Dominick, Andre, Amaan, Aaron, Julia, Jesus, Jaylen, and Bryan. It's been a pleasure to work with all of you!

If you've made it this far, remember: this chapter ends, but the story's just getting good.

~ Johnathen Tomaro

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